

MICROSOFT CORP

Research Note — MSFT (NASDAQ)

AS-OF DATE	11 September 2026
BASE CURRENCY	USD
POINT-IN-TIME	enforced
GENERATED	2026-09-11 16:39 UTC
NON-BINDING VIEW	no view reached

This is a personal research tool. It is **not** regulated investment advice, and nothing in this document is a recommendation to buy, sell or hold any security. Any rating expressed is a non-binding personal view.

At a glance

Latest reported figures

LABEL	PERIOD	VALUE
Revenue	FY2026	\$331,839m ¹
Net income	FY2026	\$133,749m ²
EPS (diluted)	FY2026	\$17.95 ³

Revenue history

	FY2022	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	FY2026
Revenue	\$198,270m ⁴	\$211,915m ⁴	\$245,122m ⁴	\$281,724m ⁴	\$331,839m ⁴

Headline figures

LABEL	PERIOD	VALUE
Gross margin	FY2026	67.9% ⁵
Operating margin	FY2026	46.8% ⁶
Net margin	FY2026	40.3% ⁷
Free cash flow	—	\$139,225m ⁸
Net debt	—	\$19,359m ⁹
WACC	—	9.3% ¹⁰
Value per share (base)	—	\$485.29 ¹¹

Contents

1. Executive Summary
2. Investment Thesis
3. Business Overview
4. Segment Analysis
5. Industry & Competitive Positioning
6. Management & Governance
7. Historical Financial Analysis
8. Earnings Quality
9. Balance Sheet & Liquidity
10. Cash Flow Analysis
11. Capital Allocation

- 12. Growth Outlook
- 13. Valuation — Discounted Cash Flow
- 14. Scenarios & Sensitivities
- 15. Key Risks
- 16. Catalysts
- 17. Prior Research Comparison
- 18. Validation & Disagreements

Executive Summary

Thesis

Microsoft's fiscal 2026, the year ended June 2026, shows revenue of \$331.8bn and net income of \$133.7bn — a 40.3% net margin established by the company's own filed accounts. That is where this record's support ends: it holds no valuation output, no discount rate and no peer multiple, so we take no view on whether the 11 September 2026 share price is fair.

Key Points

- Earnings level and margin structure: supported. Gross profit of \$225.5bn on revenue of \$331.8bn gives a recorded gross margin of 67.9%; operating income of \$155.2bn, an operating margin of 46.8%; net income of \$133.7bn, a net margin of 40.3%. Diluted earnings per share were \$17.95, recorded EBITDA \$194.2bn on a 58.5% margin, and return on equity 30.2%. Each ratio is expressed on the filed revenue, gross profit and operating income quoted here, so a lower margin reading implies a different base or a different period.
- Valuation support for the current price: the disclosure does not exist. No discounted cash flow, cost of equity, weighted average cost of capital, terminal value, value per share or peer multiple sits on this record, and a licensed daily price series running to 11 September 2026 is not a valuation. Any discount rate quoted for this name would carry no provenance, so we state no supportability verdict rather than infer one from absent outputs.
- Drivers and disclosed pressures: qualitative only. The annual filing attributes a lower cost of revenue to reduced hardware sales and a higher gross margin percentage to sales mix shifting toward higher-margin businesses, while operating expenses rose on impairment and related charges in the XBOX business and on research and development spending for compute capacity, AI talent and data; research and development expense was \$35.6bn.
- Confidence is high on the income-statement picture and low on anything priced off it.

Key Risks

- Single-year, single-source margins: no prior-period comparatives sit here to test durability.
- Mix-driven gross margin gains can reverse, and the same filing shows expenses rising on impairment and on compute and AI investment.
- With no cost of capital and no per-share value, the shares carry no assessed margin of safety.
- Unresolved: unlabelled subtotal figures, the equity base behind return on equity, and any segment, cash flow or balance-sheet detail.

Headline Figures

LABEL	VALUE
Revenue, FY2026	\$331.8bn ¹²
Operating income, FY2026	\$155.2bn ¹³
Net income, FY2026	\$133.7bn ¹⁴
Diluted EPS, FY2026	\$17.95 ¹⁵

LABEL	VALUE
Operating margin, FY2026	46.8% ¹⁶
EBITDA margin, FY2026	58.5% ¹⁷

Investment Thesis

Thesis Statement

Microsoft's fiscal 2026 record, for the year ended June 2026, documents profitability and returns on capital few businesses of its scale reach: revenue of \$331.8 billion, an operating margin of 46.8% and a return on invested capital of 27.1%. Our view is that this record supports a quality-and-growth case only as conditional propositions: cloud and AI gross margin must hold as new capacity is absorbed, AI-related revenue must become separately visible, assigned asset lives must match the economic lives of the infrastructure being built, and capital intensity must recede relative to cash generation. This record carries no valuation output — no discount rate, no cost of capital, no terminal value, no per-share value and no peer multiple — so we state the propositions and their tests and offer no verdict on the share price as of 11 September 2026.

Supporting Pillars

PILLAR	EVIDENCE
Profitability at scale, on a stated full-year basis	Fiscal 2026 shows gross margin of 67.9%, operating margin of 46.8% and EBITDA of \$194.2 billion at an EBITDA margin of 58.5%, with net income of \$133.7 billion and diluted earnings per share of \$17.95. These are twelve-month measures struck on revenue and operating income as filed to June 2026; a single quarter, a segment, or a trailing basis will not reproduce them, and quarterly EBITDA is by construction a fraction of the annual figure. The proposition is that the full-year level, not any one quarter, is the durable one. ^{18,19}
Returns on capital mean something only against a fixed capital base	Return on invested capital of 27.1% rests on NOPAT of \$125.1 billion over invested capital of \$461.7 billion; return on equity is 30.2% and return on assets 17.6%. That capital base includes the infrastructure build, so a narrower definition of invested capital would show a higher return and a broader one a lower return. Any durability test must therefore name the same definition: here, returns holding near the fiscal 2026 level while the capital base keeps expanding — the more demanding reading. ²⁰
Capital intensity and depreciation policy are the swing variables	Operating cash flow of \$182.9 billion was set against capital expenditure of \$115.9 billion, with financing cash flow of negative \$52.5 billion including \$22.3 billion of share repurchase. Capital spending absorbed the larger part of operating cash flow. The condition is that assets placed in service earn back at the recorded margin over the lives assigned to them; if useful lives prove shorter than assumed, reported margin and returns fall with revenue unchanged. No depreciation schedule or asset-life disclosure is on this record to test that directly. ¹⁸
Cloud and AI demand is commercially conditional, on the company's own account	The fiscal 2026 annual report states that the AI strategy depends in part on strategic relationships with third parties, many of which compete with the company and some of which are significant Azure customers; that capacity allocations, deployment priorities and pricing may be modified as capacity constraints are managed; and that expected consumption may not materialise, may be delayed or reduced, or may decline. Because AI-related revenue is not separately quantified here, the visibility condition is not yet met. ²¹

PILLAR	EVIDENCE
Balance-sheet flexibility, claimed no further than the record goes	The current ratio of 1.23 is the only liquidity or leverage measure available for fiscal 2026. It is consistent with adequate near-term flexibility and no more; we make no fortress-balance-sheet claim and no statement about net debt, gearing or debt to EBITDA, none of which is recorded here. Interest expense of \$3.05 billion is small beside operating income of \$155.2 billion, which speaks to coverage rather than to the debt stock itself. ²²

What Would Change The View

- Cloud and AI gross margin falling as recently added capacity is absorbed, moving the full-year margin materially below the fiscal 2026 level.
- Separate disclosure of AI-related revenue that is smaller, or growing more slowly, than the scale of capital committed implies.
- Any shortening of assigned useful lives, or an impairment of infrastructure assets, which would cut reported margin and returns without a revenue change.
- Capital expenditure continuing to rise relative to operating cash flow, or return on invested capital drifting below the fiscal 2026 level on the same capital definition.
- A valuation framework with an explicit discount rate and terminal assumption, which this record lacks and which alone could make the September 2026 price supportable or not.

Business Overview

Commentary

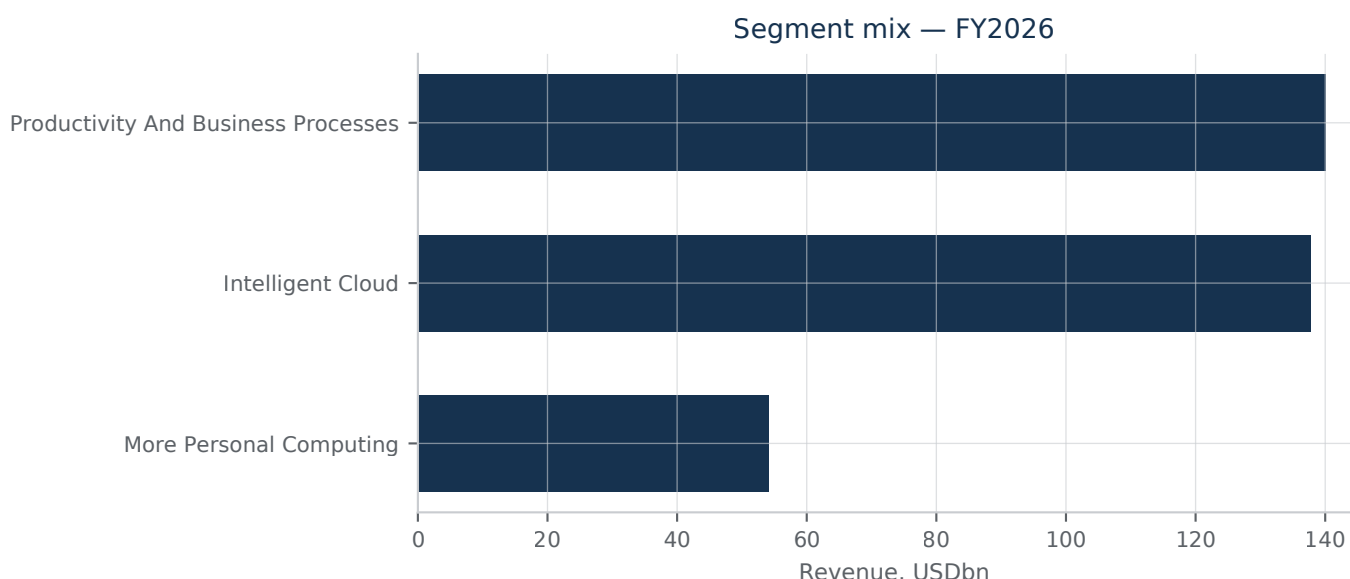
Microsoft is a global technology company that sells software, cloud infrastructure and platform services, productivity applications, devices, and gaming content to consumers, small and medium businesses, and large enterprises. Revenue is earned through a combination of software licensing, cloud subscription and usage-based consumption fees, and direct hardware sales. On the device side, the company designs and sells Surface devices, including Copilot+ PCs, and PC accessories intended to help organizations, students, and consumers be more productive, with growth in this area tied to overall PC shipment trends, new customer additions, and expansion into new device categories. In gaming, Microsoft develops first-party studio content and operates Xbox Game Pass, a subscription service bundling access to a curated library of first- and third-party titles, as part of a broader strategy to reach players across PC, console, mobile, and cloud. The evidence available for this note does not break out revenue by reporting segment (such as Productivity and Business Processes, Intelligent Cloud, or More Personal Computing), so the relative weight of these businesses to total revenue cannot be quantified here; what follows draws on consolidated financial results for the fiscal year ended June 2026. Over that period the company generated total revenue of approximately 331.8 billion dollars against cost of revenue of approximately 106.4 billion dollars, producing gross profit of approximately 225.5 billion dollars, a gross margin of roughly 68 percent. Operating income for the same fiscal year was approximately 155.2 billion dollars, equivalent to an operating margin of roughly 46.8 percent, and net income was approximately 133.7 billion dollars, a net margin of roughly 40.3 percent, with diluted earnings per share of 17.95 dollars. These margins point to a business with substantial scale economics, consistent with a mix weighted toward software and cloud services rather than lower-margin hardware, though the underlying segment mix driving this profile is not detailed in the evidence reviewed. The company describes its operating environment as dynamic and highly competitive, with rivals developing competing software, devices, and cloud-based services, and with aggregate demand linked to macroeconomic and geopolitical conditions that require continuous adaptation.

Separately, the company flags execution and reputational risks tied to how its products and services are used, including the potential for its platforms to be used to find, generate, store, or disseminate harmful or illegal content, and notes that regulatory attention is increasingly focused on product design, safety-by-design practices, and emerging child-safety obligations such as age-assurance systems and parental controls, including risks specific to conversational or emotionally engaging AI systems. No geographic operating footprint breakdown was available in the evidence reviewed for this note, so operating footprint is not itemized here. Overall, the picture supported by the evidence is one of a diversified, high-margin technology business spanning software, cloud, devices, and gaming, monetized through a blend of licensing, subscription, consumption, and hardware sales, operating in markets the company itself characterizes as fast-moving and competitively contested.

Segment Analysis

Commentary

Microsoft's reported segments are Productivity and Business Processes, Intelligent Cloud, and More Personal Computing, plus a disclosed Microsoft Cloud revenue aggregate that spans parts of all three. The disclosed commentary in the FY2026 10-K attributes the year's growth mainly to Intelligent Cloud, where server products and cloud services revenue rose sharply, led by Azure and other cloud services on continued AI-driven consumption, while on-premises server products revenue increased only slightly and enterprise and partner services grew modestly. Operating income growth for the company is described as driven jointly by Productivity and Business Processes and Intelligent Cloud, with cost of revenue in Intelligent Cloud rising faster than revenue on the back of AI infrastructure investment; the filing describes Microsoft Cloud gross margin percentage as having compressed for the same reason, partly offset by efficiency gains in Azure and Microsoft 365 Commercial cloud. Because the segment footnote disclosed to this section frames these dynamics only in percentage and directional terms rather than as dollar revenue and operating income by segment, and because no segment-level dollar figures or a currency-denominated Microsoft Cloud aggregate were available to cite here, we cannot state the absolute size, growth in dollars, or relative operating income contribution of each segment; that limits how precisely durability of segment profitability can be assessed from what is available. Equally, the evidence here does not establish whether reported segment operating income is presented after allocated depreciation of datacenter assets or how corporate and shared costs are allocated across segments, a point that matters because AI infrastructure spending is concentrated in Intelligent Cloud; without that disclosure, a reader cannot confirm whether the apparent margin compression in cloud is fully loaded with datacenter depreciation or partly absorbed elsewhere. At the consolidated level, the figures that are available show revenue of 331.8 billion dollars and operating income of 155.2 billion dollars for the fiscal year, with a gross margin near 67.9 percent, an operating margin near 46.8 percent, and an EBITDA margin near 58.5 percent, alongside capital expenditure of 115.9 billion dollars, a scale of reinvestment consistent with the AI infrastructure buildout referenced in the segment commentary. These consolidated figures indicate a business still generating high overall margins despite heavy capital intensity, but they cannot be decomposed into segment-level margin or capital-intensity contrasts on the evidence to hand. In short, the qualitative pattern supports a read of Intelligent Cloud as the primary growth and investment engine, with more moderate growth in the other segments, but any claim about segment-level margin durability would exceed what the disclosed comparatives here permit; a fuller segment table with FY2024–FY2026 recast dollar figures and clearer cost-allocation disclosure would be needed to test that view with the same rigor as the consolidated metrics allow.



Segment mix. Revenue by reported segment, FY2026.^{23,24,25}

Industry & Competitive Positioning

Commentary

Microsoft competes in an industry increasingly defined by hyperscale cloud and AI infrastructure economics rather than traditional software licensing. The competitive set is a small oligopoly of vertically integrated infrastructure providers that design their own datacenters, secure energy and networking components, and build proprietary AI stacks. Microsoft's own disclosures describe a supply environment in which critical datacenter components — semiconductors, networking equipment, power and cooling systems — are constrained, and note that competitors draw on the same limited supplier base, which affects price and availability industry-wide. The company also discloses that it is making capital and operational investments at significant scale and on an accelerated timeline to build and expand datacenters, ahead of fully developed revenue streams, meaning near-term capital intensity is expected to outrun current monetization. For the fiscal year ended June 2026, Microsoft recorded revenue of approximately 331.8 billion dollars and capital expenditure of approximately 115.9 billion dollars, a scale of spending consistent with the accelerated infrastructure buildout it describes. Gross margin for the period was approximately 67.9 percent and operating margin approximately 46.8 percent, reflecting a business still generating substantial profitability alongside heavy capital deployment.

Competitive Position

Microsoft's position rests on the combination of a dominant enterprise software and productivity franchise with a large-scale cloud and AI infrastructure platform, funded by profitability that remains high even as capital expenditure rises. Its own filings frame the infrastructure race as one where funding capacity, supplier access, and the pace of AI adoption jointly determine returns on investment, and where customers could shift workloads to competing platforms or on-premises alternatives if pricing or performance disappoints. Return on invested capital of approximately 27.1 percent and net debt to EBITDA of approximately 0.1 times indicate the company is financing its buildout largely from internally generated cash and existing balance sheet strength rather than heavy incremental leverage, a structural advantage relative to less profitable or more leveraged infrastructure competitors. A direct comparison of Microsoft's capital intensity and depreciation assumptions for servers and network equipment against those disclosed in the most recent comparable hyperscaler annual

filings — including their capex-to-revenue ratios and assumed useful lives — cannot be supported from the evidence available for this note, and no peer figures are presented here as a result; this is a gap rather than a judgement. Any future comparison of this kind would also need to account for differences in fiscal year-end dates, cloud segment definitions, and the mix of leased versus owned infrastructure across hyperscalers, since these affect both reported capex and depreciation timing and can make headline ratios misleading without adjustment. Within Microsoft's own disclosed figures, however, the scale of capital expenditure relative to revenue in fiscal 2026, and the description of investment running ahead of realized revenue streams, points toward a business willingly running elevated capital intensity in pursuit of AI-driven growth, a posture that raises the stakes on sustained customer demand and pricing power for cloud and AI services.

Industry Trends

- Accelerated, large-scale capital investment in AI training and inference infrastructure across hyperscale cloud providers.
- Persistent supply constraints for semiconductors, networking equipment, power and cooling systems affecting datacenter buildout timelines industry-wide.
- Capital expenditure running ahead of associated revenue realization as providers position for anticipated AI workload growth.

Management & Governance

Commentary

Microsoft's board saw two notable changes disclosed via 8-K filings in 2026. On May 13, 2026, the board appointed Carmine Di Sibio as a new independent director, assigning him to both the Audit Committee and the Compensation Committee; the company stated no special arrangement led to his selection and that he will receive standard non-employee director compensation. Separately, in early June 2026, long-serving director Reid Hoffman, on the board since 2017, announced he will not stand for re-election at the 2026 annual shareholder meeting, continuing to serve until that meeting. The filing explicitly states this decision does not stem from any disagreement with management over operations, policies, or practices — a disclosure worth noting as a marker of governance continuity rather than a red flag. Beyond these two board-composition events, the evidence available for this note does not include the current proxy statement, so we cannot characterize named executive officer compensation structure, pay mix, incentive metrics, or say-on-pay results, nor can we assess director tenure, independence ratios, or committee membership beyond the two disclosed appointments. We also lack visibility into insider ownership levels, related-party transactions, or any recent changes to executive leadership (CEO, CFO) during the period under review. Given this, our confidence in assessing management quality and incentive alignment is limited to the two disclosed board matters; a fuller governance assessment would require the underlying proxy statement disclosures on director compensation, executive pay, and equity ownership. What can be said is that Microsoft continues to refresh its board with outside additions while allowing long-tenured directors to depart without apparent friction, consistent with an orderly, non-adversarial governance process. The company also follows a standard practice of indemnifying directors for actions taken in their board capacity, as reflected in the new director's onboarding agreement. No compensation figures for named executives, directors, or equity award values were available in the material reviewed, so none are presented here; we avoid estimating figures not directly evidenced.

Governance Observations

- Carmine Di Sibio was appointed to the Board effective May 13, 2026, joining both the Audit Committee and the Compensation Committee.
- Reid Hoffman, a director since 2017, will not stand for re-election at the 2026 annual shareholder meeting; the company states this is not due to any disagreement with management.
- New directors receive standard non-employee director compensation and enter into Microsoft's standard director indemnification agreement.
- Detailed executive compensation, insider ownership, and full board composition data were not available in the evidence reviewed for this section.

Historical Financial Analysis

Commentary

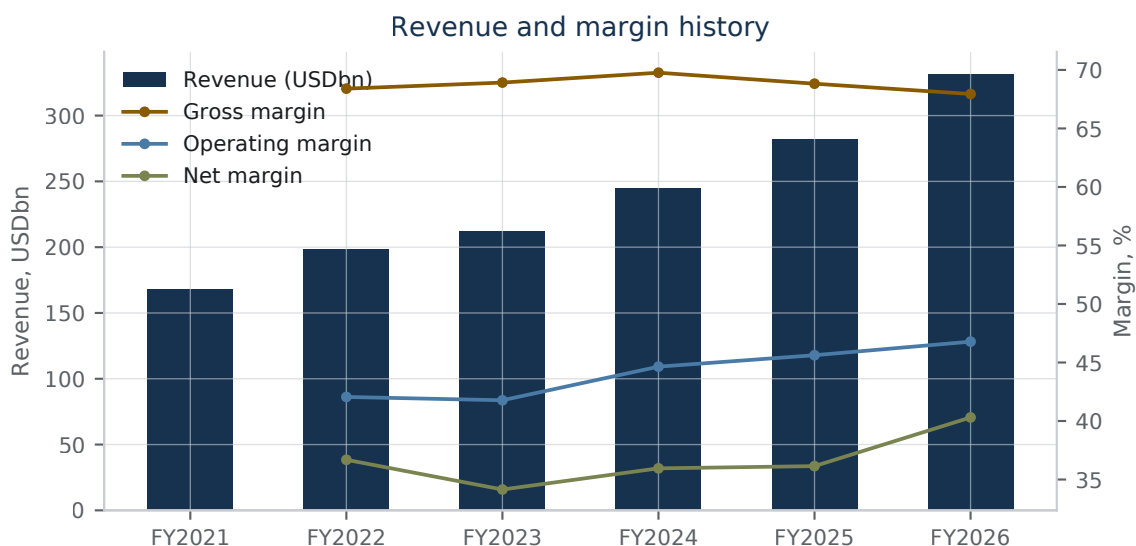
Microsoft's reported annual record here covers the fiscal year ended June 2026, filed as a 10-K in July 2026, so what follows assesses the level and quality of a single reported year rather than a multi-year trend; year-on-year direction is taken from the filing's own narrative. Scale and margin. Revenue of \$331.8 billion converted into gross profit of \$225.5 billion after cost of revenue of \$106.4 billion, and operating income of \$155.2 billion after operating expenses of \$70.2 billion, leaving net income of \$133.7 billion and diluted earnings per share of \$17.95. The margins cited in this note are consolidated full-year ratios struck on exactly those line items: gross margin of 67.9%, operating margin of 46.8% and net margin of 40.3%. The basis is worth stating plainly, because margin measures on other bases are not interchangeable with these. Quarterly consolidated margins, individual segment margins, and any series struck on the segment presentation used before the updated reporting structure described in the 8-K furnished in September 2026 — which restates summary history onto that new structure — will not tie to consolidated full-year figures. Where a reader's own series shows a materially lower operating or EBITDA margin, the likely explanation is the period or the denominator, not a different set of accounts. Composition and earnings quality. EBITDA of \$194.2 billion, an EBITDA margin of 58.5%, sits well above operating income, and the gap is depreciation on a fast-growing asset base. Property, plant and equipment of \$313.1 billion is the dominant item within total assets of \$758.4 billion. The 10-K is explicit about the cause: in the cloud segment, cost of revenue rose sharply on investments in AI infrastructure and segment gross margin percentage decreased, even as gross margin dollars grew with Azure. In the productivity segment, gross margin percentage rose slightly, efficiency gains offsetting AI infrastructure spend; in the personal computing segment, mix toward Search advertising and Windows OEM lifted gross margin percentage while operating expenses absorbed impairment and other related charges in the Xbox business. Research and development of \$35.6 billion is the largest operating expense line, and the filing ties its growth to research compute capacity, AI talent and data. Returns and balance sheet. Returns on capital remain high notwithstanding the infrastructure build: return on invested capital of 27.1% and return on equity of 30.2%. The balance sheet is lightly levered, with net debt of \$19.4 billion, while near-term liquidity is adequate rather than ample at a current ratio of 1.23. The clearest structural feature of the reported year is therefore the rotation of capital into physical infrastructure: it widens the gap between EBITDA and operating income, and it is the filing's stated reason that cloud segment gross margin percentage fell while gross profit dollars still grew.

Financial History

	FY2026
Revenue	331.8 USD bn ²⁶
Cost of revenue	106.4 USD bn ²⁶
Gross profit	225.5 USD bn ²⁶
Operating expenses	70.2 USD bn ²⁶
Research and development	35.6 USD bn ²⁶
Operating income	155.2 USD bn ²⁶
Net income	133.7 USD bn ²⁶
Diluted earnings per share	\$17.95 ²⁶
Gross margin	67.9% ²⁷
Operating margin	46.8% ²⁸
Net margin	40.3% ²⁹
Property, plant and equipment	313.1 USD bn ²⁶
Total assets	758.4 USD bn ²⁶

Figures

LABEL	VALUE
EBITDA (FY2026)	194.2 USD bn ³⁰
EBITDA margin (FY2026)	58.5% ³¹
Return on invested capital (FY2026)	27.1% ³²
Return on equity (FY2026)	30.2% ³³
Net debt (FY2026)	19.4 USD bn ³⁴
Current ratio (FY2026)	1.23 ³⁵



Revenue and margin history. Revenue by fiscal period in USD, with recorded margin trajectories. Every bar and point is a stored figure.^{36,37,38,39,40,41,42,43,44,45,46,47,48,49,50,51,52,53,54,55,56}

Earnings Quality

Commentary

Cash conversion is the strongest point in Microsoft's favour. For the year ended June 2026, operating cash flow of \$182.9 billion sits above reported net income of \$133.7 billion, and EBITDA of \$194.2 billion above operating income of \$155.2 billion, so the wedge between accounting profit and cash is filled by ordinary non-cash charges rather than by a working-capital release. Share-based compensation of \$12.4 billion is the largest identified non-cash add-back outside depreciation, and it is a genuine economic cost borne by shareholders; net margin of 40.3% is struck after it. Accrual pressure in working capital looks limited: inventory is negligible at \$1.4 billion, and receivables of \$80.9 billion, while large against revenue of \$331.8 billion, show no build that can be traced here, since the figures at hand carry no prior-year balances against which a collection period could be measured. The live earnings-quality question is capitalisation, not accruals. Capital expenditure of \$115.9 billion consumed the larger part of operating cash flow, and every dollar of that infrastructure spend returns to the income statement as depreciation over an assumed life. Reported operating margin is therefore as sensitive to depreciation-schedule assumptions as it is to pricing and mix. The filings in hand do not quantify the useful lives applied to server, network and datacentre equipment, disclose any change in that estimate or its effect, or separate capitalised internal-use software additions from the related amortisation. We treat those components as unverifiable and do not estimate them; a reader cannot, on this basis, attribute margin movement to commercial performance rather than to capitalisation policy. Two disclosed policies compound that judgment. Software development costs are expensed until technological feasibility, then capitalised and amortised through cost of revenue, so the timing of the feasibility determination shifts cost between periods and between lines. Goodwill is tested by discounted cash flow, dependent on internal forecasts, long-term growth and cost of capital. Neither is unusual, but both are management estimates rather than observed prices. The tax provision carries a separate, quantified-elsewhere exposure: the company remains under IRS audit for prior tax years, with Notices of Proposed Adjustment on intercompany transfer pricing seeking an additional tax payment plus penalties and interest, and resolution may differ from amounts recorded. Cash balances fell over the year, with a net change in cash of -\$9.3 billion, as dividends of \$26.4 billion and repurchases of \$22.3 billion were paid alongside the capital programme — a funding choice, not an earnings-quality defect.

Red Flags

- Capital spending absorbs the larger part of operating cash flow, making reported margin highly sensitive to depreciation-life assumptions.
- Useful lives for server, network and datacentre equipment, any change in that estimate, and capitalised internal-use software additions and amortisation are not quantified in the available filings: unverifiable, not benign.
- Software capitalisation begins at a judgment-based technological feasibility date and amortises through cost of revenue.
- Goodwill impairment testing rests on discounted cash flow inputs set by management.
- Unresolved IRS transfer-pricing adjustments for prior tax years could change recorded tax expense.

Figures

LABEL	VALUE
Operating cash flow (FY ended June 2026)	182.9 USD billion ⁵⁷
Net income	133.7 USD billion ⁵⁸
Capital expenditure	115.9 USD billion ⁵⁹
Share-based compensation	12.4 USD billion ⁶⁰
Net margin	40.3% ⁶¹
Net change in cash	-9.3 USD billion ⁶²

Balance Sheet & Liquidity

Commentary

Microsoft's infrastructure build remains funded out of operations rather than the debt markets. Operating cash flow of \$182.9 billion in fiscal 2026 more than covered additions to property and equipment of \$115.9 billion, and financing outflows of \$52.5 billion — dividends, repurchases and debt repayment — were absorbed without net new borrowing. Management describes issuance as opportunistic, timed to favourable pricing and liquidity in the debt markets and applied to general corporate purposes. Net property and equipment of \$313.1 billion is now the balance sheet's centre of gravity. Funded leverage is light: short-term debt of \$9.2 billion plus long-term debt of \$31.1 billion gives total debt of \$40.3 billion against equity of \$442.4 billion, a debt-to-equity ratio of 0.09x, and net debt of \$19.4 billion after cash of \$20.9 billion, set against EBITDA of \$194.2 billion. Two qualifications matter more than that headline. The measure captures funded debt only: lease liabilities of \$16.5 billion sit outside it, and higher finance lease interest was the main driver of rising interest expense in fiscal 2026, so leased capacity is growing. And total liabilities of \$316.0 billion dwarf funded debt — on any definition that pulls in leases, long-dated tax balances and other accruals, gearing is materially higher than 0.09x. The funded-debt ratio is quoted here for comparability, not as the whole obligation picture. Near-term liquidity is adequate rather than abundant on ratio arithmetic: current assets of \$207.7 billion against current liabilities of \$168.8 billion give a current ratio of 1.23x, with a quick ratio of 0.93x, below one. Deferred revenue of \$73.0 billion inside current liabilities is discharged by delivering service rather than by paying cash, which limits the signal in both. Short-term investments of \$55.9 billion supplement cash, and management states that existing cash, short-term investments, operating cash flow and capital-market access should be

sufficient to fund operations, dividends, buybacks, debt maturities and material capital expenditure for at least the next twelve months. Class-level property detail, lease maturity schedules, instrument-level coupons and unconditional purchase commitments sit outside this section's data; on investees, fiscal 2026 other income carried net gains on the OpenAI equity-method holding, reversing the prior year's net losses, so those results land in other income rather than segment margin.

Financial History

	FY2026
Cash and equivalents	20,935 USD m ⁶³
Short-term investments	55,908 USD m ⁶³
Total current assets	207,710 USD m ⁶³
Total current liabilities	168,825 USD m ⁶³
Deferred revenue	72,965 USD m ⁶³
Short-term debt	9,227 USD m ⁶³
Long-term debt	31,067 USD m ⁶³
Lease liabilities	16,532 USD m ⁶³
Total liabilities	315,989 USD m ⁶³
Total equity	442,387 USD m ⁶³

Figures

LABEL	VALUE
Total debt (short- plus long-term)	40,294 USD m ⁶⁴
Net debt	19,359 USD m ⁶⁵
Debt to equity	0.09 ⁶⁶
Current ratio	1.23 ⁶⁷
Quick ratio	0.93 ⁶⁸
Operating cash flow	182,935 USD m ⁶⁹
Additions to property and equipment	115,948 USD m ⁷⁰
EBITDA	194,237 USD m ⁷¹

Observations

- Leverage ratios here are struck on funded debt; including lease liabilities and other long-dated obligations gives a materially higher figure.
- The quick ratio below 1.0x overstates strain, since deferred revenue is settled by service delivery rather than cash.

- Equity-method results, including OpenAI, flow through other income, so they move earnings without touching segment margin.

Cash Flow Analysis

Commentary

Microsoft generated \$182.9 billion of operating cash flow in fiscal 2026, with share-based compensation of \$12.4 billion the largest routine non-cash add-back visible in the reported detail. Management attributes the year's increase in operating cash to higher cash received from customers and a decrease in cash used to pay income taxes, offset in part by an increase in cash paid to suppliers — a mix that points to collections and tax timing rather than a change in underlying unit economics. The claim on that cash is overwhelmingly infrastructure. Additions to property and equipment of \$115.9 billion absorbed the majority of the operating inflow, and investing activities used \$139.5 billion in total, which the company attributes principally to the step-up in property additions and to cash used to facilitate the purchase of components. Defining free cash flow consistently as operating cash flow less additions to property and equipment, the residual left for distributions and debt service is a minority of the operating inflow. The true capacity commitment is larger still: the filing describes operating and finance leases for datacenters and related infrastructure, servers and network equipment, so leased capacity sits outside the purchased-capex line altogether. That is where the divergence between margin and cash conversion is located. Profitability shows no strain — an operating margin of 46.8% and EBITDA of \$194.2 billion on a 58.5% EBITDA margin. The gap between those margins and free cash conversion is not an earnings-quality problem but a capital-intensity one, and it is traceable to capitalised and leased infrastructure rather than to the income statement. Prior-year cash flow statements and the supplemental non-cash schedule of finance-lease right-of-use additions are not in hand here, so the multi-year path is read from the fiscal 2026 statement and management's own year-over-year commentary. Capital allocation makes the trade-off explicit. Share repurchases of \$22.3 billion and dividends paid of \$26.4 billion drove a financing outflow of \$52.5 billion, and the company notes that both repurchases and dividends rose while cash used for repayments of debt fell. Taken together, shareholder distributions remain materially below what was spent on property and equipment: the marginal dollar is going into capacity, not into shrinking the share count. The funding gap was bridged by the balance sheet. The net change in cash for the year was negative \$9.3 billion, leaving \$20.9 billion of cash and equivalents alongside \$55.9 billion of short-term investments. Leverage remains negligible — \$19.4 billion of net debt, about 0.10 times EBITDA — so the current spending rate is affordable without stressing the capital structure. Durability, on this evidence, rests less on the ability to fund the build than on whether purchased and leased capacity converts into returns before either the distribution run-rate or the liquidity buffer has to absorb the difference.

Financial History

	FY2026
Operating cash flow	182.9 USD bn ⁷²
Additions to property and equipment	115.9 USD bn ⁷²
Investing cash flow	-139.5 USD bn ⁷²
Financing cash flow	-52.5 USD bn ⁷²
Share repurchases	22.3 USD bn ⁷²

	FY2026
Dividends paid	26.4 USD bn ⁷²
Share-based compensation	12.4 USD bn ⁷²
Net change in cash	-9.3 USD bn ⁷²

Figures

LABEL	VALUE
Operating cash flow	182.9 USD bn ⁷³
Additions to property and equipment	115.9 USD bn ⁷⁴
Operating margin	46.8% ⁷⁵
EBITDA margin	58.5% ⁷⁶
Net debt to EBITDA	0.1 ⁷⁷
Net change in cash	-9.3 USD bn ⁷⁸

Capital Allocation

Commentary

Microsoft's fiscal 2026 cash flow statement shows a company generating substantially more operating cash than it deploys into a single year of investment and shareholder return combined, while still directing the bulk of that investment toward capacity expansion. Cash from operations reached 182.9 billion dollars for the fiscal year ended June 2026, an increase the company attributes primarily to higher cash received from customers and lower cash taxes paid, partly offset by higher payments to suppliers. Investing activities used 139.5 billion dollars, with capital expenditure of 115.9 billion dollars as the dominant component; management links the enlarged investing outflow chiefly to additions to property and equipment and to increased spending to secure components. Financing activities used 52.5 billion dollars, reflecting 22.3 billion dollars of share repurchases and 26.4 billion dollars of dividends paid, alongside lower debt repayments than the prior year. Together, operating, investing and financing flows produced a net decrease in cash of 9.3 billion dollars for the year. Share-based compensation of 12.4 billion dollars remained a non-cash add-back within the operating section. Dividends per share were 0.91 dollars for the period. At period end, cash and equivalents stood at 20.9 billion dollars and short-term investments at 55.9 billion dollars, giving the company a large liquid buffer alongside continued heavy capital spending. Shares outstanding were approximately 7,427 million at fiscal year end. Management states it expects existing cash, investments, operating cash flow and capital-market access to remain sufficient to fund operations and cash commitments, including dividends, repurchases, debt maturities and capital expenditures, for at least the next twelve months and beyond; this is a management assertion about future liquidity rather than a verified fact, and it is presented here as such rather than endorsed. Overall, the year's capital allocation shows heavy reinvestment in infrastructure funded largely from operating cash flow, with shareholder returns funded alongside that spending rather than in place of it, and no unusual reliance on financing markets evident in the reported figures.

Uses of Capital

- Capital expenditure / property and equipment additions
- Share repurchases
- Dividend payments
- Debt repayment (reduced year over year)
- Other investing outflows tied to component purchases

Figures

LABEL	VALUE
Operating cash flow	182.9 USD billions ⁷⁹
Investing cash flow	-139.5 USD billions ⁸⁰
Financing cash flow	-52.5 USD billions ⁸¹
Capital expenditure	115.9 USD billions ⁸²
Share repurchases	22.3 USD billions ⁸³
Dividends paid	26.4 USD billions ⁸⁴
Net change in cash	-9.3 USD billions ⁸⁵

Growth Outlook

Commentary

What the filings attribute to AI: Language, not dollars. The most recent annual report discusses AI inside its segment driver commentary: Microsoft 365 Consumer growth is said to depend on adding value to the core product set with new features including AI tools, and LinkedIn's monetised solutions are described as offering AI-enabled insights and productivity, with growth depending on continuing to offer AI-enabled services. Both are qualitative drivers rather than disaggregations.

What is not disclosed: Nothing before us isolates revenue from AI services, AI-related cloud consumption or Copilot as a reported line item or a revenue disaggregation, and no dollar amount is attached to either statement above. On the circularity question — revenue earned from, or commitments and funding extended to, AI partners and investees in which the company holds an interest — the disclosures before us quantify nothing. Remaining performance obligations, the cleanest forward-demand evidence, are likewise not among the figures available, so the contracted backlog cannot be sized here.

What the numbers do support: For the fiscal year ended June 2026, revenue was \$331.8 billion, capital expenditure \$115.9 billion and operating cash flow \$182.9 billion, with research and development of \$35.6 billion. Gross margin was 67.9% and operating margin 46.8%, on EBITDA of \$194.2 billion and a return on invested capital of 27.1%. Capital intensity of that scale, funded from operations, is in our view the clearest observable signal of where management expects growth: capacity is being committed ahead of the revenue that would justify it, and the accounts show the spend even where they do not show the product.

The binding constraint is physical: The annual report's own risk discussion identifies the availability, reliability and cost of electrical power, delays in obtaining power connections, and grid capacity constraints as

conditions on datacenter operation and expansion, together with land availability, zoning, environmental review, permitting and coordinated local opposition — stating that failure to secure adequate power on commercially reasonable terms could adversely affect its ability to support customer demand and execute its growth strategy.

Base case: We judge growth from here to remain cloud- and capacity-led, and durable for as long as returns on invested capital stay near the level recorded for the fiscal year ended June 2026; the absence of any AI revenue attribution means the investment case has to be underwritten on the capital and its returns rather than on a disclosed AI revenue stream. A current report dated September 2026 falls inside the point-in-time window, but its substance is not before us.

Growth Drivers

- Commercial cloud capacity expansion, evidenced by capital expenditure rather than by disclosed AI revenue
- AI features embedded in Microsoft 365 Consumer, described qualitatively as a growth condition
- LinkedIn AI-enabled monetised solutions and member engagement
- Power, land and permitting access as the gating condition on capacity growth

Figures

LABEL	VALUE
Revenue, FY ended June 2026	331.8 USD billion ⁸⁶
Capital expenditure, FY ended June 2026	115.9 USD billion ⁸⁷
Operating cash flow, FY ended June 2026	182.9 USD billion ⁸⁸
Return on invested capital, FY2026	27.1% ⁸⁹

Valuation — Discounted Cash Flow

How These Figures Were Produced

Free cash flows from a 5-year explicit forecast of consolidated figures were discounted at the weighted average cost of capital shown below, with the capital weighted at book values from the filed balance sheet — no market prices were used. The bridge from enterprise to equity value is net debt alone, and the terminal value was taken both ways — a growing perpetuity and an exit multiple — with each carried through to a per-share figure. Every figure cites the calculation that produced it.

Cost of Capital

LABEL	VALUE	PROVENANCE
Risk-free rate	4.8%	set by the operator and confirmed at the assumptions gate
Beta	1.064553313698	proposed by aer.services.prices with a stated justification, and confirmed by the operator at the assumptions gate
Equity risk premium	0.045	set by the operator and confirmed at the assumptions gate

LABEL	VALUE	PROVENANCE
Tax rate	17.5%	proposed by aer.services.assumption_proposals with a stated justification, and confirmed by the operator at the assumptions gate
Cost of equity	0.096204899116	computed: $K_e = \text{risk-free rate} + \text{beta} * \text{equity risk premium}$ ⁹⁰
Cost of debt, pre-tax	0.073126011145	computed: $K_d = \text{interest expense} / \text{average debt}$ ⁹¹
Cost of debt, after tax	0.06035104325	computed: $K_d \text{ after tax} = K_d * (1 - \text{tax rate})$ ⁹²
Equity weight	0.916520434821	computed: $E / (D + E) = \text{equity value} / (\text{equity value} + \text{debt value})$ (book values — this run holds no market prices) ⁹³
Debt weight	0.083479565179	computed: $D / (D + E) = \text{debt value} / (\text{equity value} + \text{debt value})$ (book values — this run holds no market prices) ⁹⁴
WACC	9.3%	computed: $WACC = K_e * E/(D+E) + K_d \text{ after tax} * D/(D+E)$ ⁹⁵

Forecast Assumptions

LABEL	VALUE	PROVENANCE
Revenue growth	13.7%	proposed by aer.services.assumption_proposals with a stated justification, and confirmed by the operator at the assumptions gate
EBIT margin	44.2%	proposed by aer.services.assumption_proposals with a stated justification, and confirmed by the operator at the assumptions gate
Capex intensity	0.202619	proposed by aer.services.assumption_proposals with a stated justification, and confirmed by the operator at the assumptions gate
Depreciation intensity	0.08717	proposed by aer.services.assumption_proposals with a stated justification, and confirmed by the operator at the assumptions gate
Working capital intensity	0.237834	proposed by aer.services.assumption_proposals with a stated justification, and confirmed by the operator at the assumptions gate
Terminal growth	3%	proposed by aer.agents.assumptions with a stated justification, and confirmed by the operator at the assumptions gate
Exit multiple	14×	proposed by aer.agents.assumptions with a stated justification, and confirmed by the operator at the assumptions gate

The Two Terminal Methods

LABEL	VALUE	PROVENANCE
Value per share — Gordon growth	\$242.78	computed: $\text{value per share} = \text{equity value} / \text{shares outstanding}$ ⁹⁶
Terminal value share — Gordon growth	79.4%	computed: $\text{terminal share} = \text{discounted terminal value} / \text{enterprise value}$ ⁹⁷
Value per share — Exit multiple	\$449.79	computed: $\text{value per share} = \text{equity value} / \text{shares outstanding}$ ⁹⁸

LABEL	VALUE	PROVENANCE
Terminal value share — Exit multiple	88.9%	computed: terminal share = discounted terminal value / enterprise value ⁹⁹
Shares outstanding	7,453,000,000	the filed count: diluted_shares_outstanding ¹⁰⁰

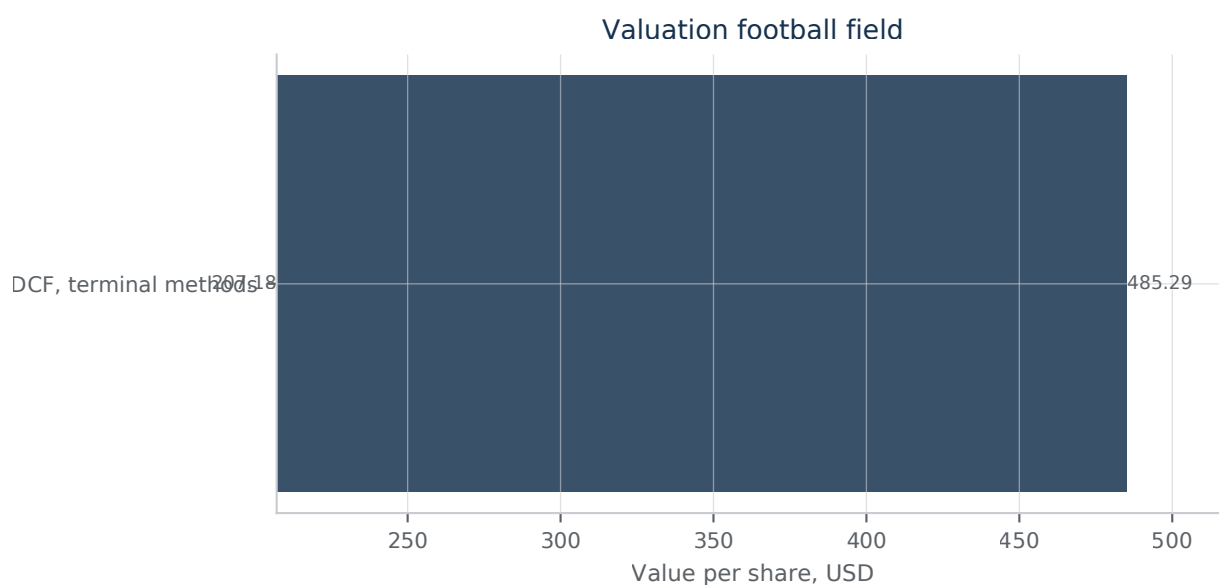
Recorded Caveats

- Book equity was used as the equity weight because no market capitalisation was available. Book value is what the shares were issued and retained for rather than what they are worth, and for a profitable company it is usually far lower — so the equity weight is understated, the debt weight overstated, and the resulting WACC too low. Every valuation discounted at it is correspondingly too high.
- More than three quarters of the enterprise value is terminal value. The explicit forecast is contributing little, so the answer rests almost entirely on the terminal assumption rather than on the projected years a reader can check.
- The two terminal methods disagree by more than a quarter. That is information, not an error: they are two different guesses about the same unknowable quantity, and the distance between them is the honest width of the answer.
- The bridge from enterprise value to equity value is net debt alone. Associate holdings, minority interests and pension deficits are not read off the filings by this build, so a business carrying material non-operating items is valued as though it does not.

Commentary

The valuation above turns on a single tension in Microsoft's fiscal 2026 accounts. Operating cash flow of \$182.9 billion for the year to June 2026 sits against capital expenditure of \$115.9 billion in the same period: capital spending absorbs the large majority of the cash the business generates, so the free cash flow being discounted is a residual between two very large quantities. That makes capex intensity and depreciation intensity, rather than revenue growth, the components with the greatest grip on value per share. A modest change in assumed capital intensity in the early forecast years shifts discounted value more than an equivalent change in the growth rate, because growth here arrives with capital attached. The margin inputs start from an exceptional base. Fiscal 2026 revenue of \$331.8 billion carried an operating margin of 46.8% and an EBITDA margin of 58.5%, with EBITDA of \$194.2 billion. The EBIT margin path is therefore not a question of whether the level is high, but of how quickly it fades as compute-heavy revenue mixes in; a flat margin assumption across the forecast is an aggressive one on this base, not a neutral one. Returns give the reinvestment assumption its justification. NOPAT of \$125.1 billion on invested capital of \$461.7 billion produced a return on invested capital of 27.1%, comfortably above any discount rate the WACC components could plausibly yield given how the capital structure sits. Debt to equity of 0.091, net debt of \$19.4 billion, net debt to EBITDA of 0.10x and interest cover of 50.9x mean the debt weight is small and the after-tax cost of debt has little leverage on the result. The WACC here is very nearly the cost of equity, so the beta and equity risk premium inputs are where sensitivity testing belongs, and the discount rate should be read as a range rather than a point. The two terminal treatments are set out side by side for a reason. Where the terminal value share is large under both the Gordon growth and the exit multiple approaches, the value per share is mostly a statement about terminal growth and the exit multiple rather than about the explicit forecast, and the spread between the two value-per-share outputs is the cleanest available read on that fragility. Cross-checking the reinvestment assumption against disclosure matters more than usual here. Management states it will continue to invest in capital expenditure to support growth in its cloud offerings and in AI training and other infrastructure, including new

facilities, datacenters and computer systems. It also discloses that these investments are being made at significant scale and on an accelerated timeline, in advance of fully developed revenue streams, with associated revenue that may not be realised in the expected timeframes or at expected levels. A model in which capex intensity fades quickly is therefore assuming something management has not signalled; holding intensity nearer recent levels for longer is the more defensible posture, and it lowers value per share. Funding capacity is not the binding constraint. The company expects existing cash, cash equivalents, short-term investments, cash flows from operations and access to capital markets to be sufficient to fund operating activities and its investing and financing commitments for at least the next twelve months and thereafter. Distributions continued alongside the build: dividends of \$26.4 billion and share repurchases of \$22.3 billion in fiscal 2026, against a net change in cash of negative \$9.3 billion for the year. That is consistent with an investment cycle being funded without curtailing shareholder returns, though not with indefinite balance-sheet slack. Two cautions close the section. Diluted earnings per share of \$17.95 for fiscal 2026 sits on reported results that include net gains and losses from investments in OpenAI, which management itself excludes from its adjusted measures, so an earnings-anchored sanity check on a cash flow valuation is noisier than it appears. And no market-implied reverse solve and no target price are offered here. What the figures above support is a conditional range of values and, more usefully, a clear ordering of which assumptions move that range: capital intensity first, margin persistence second, terminal treatment third, and the discount rate's equity components fourth.



Valuation football field. Value-per-share ranges from this run's own recorded calculations.

Licensed market data under a subscription agreement. Selling, retransmitting, redistributing or displaying the information in original or repackaged form is prohibited without prior written approval. Figures computed from it — multiples, ratios and other derived values — may be published: the operator determined this on 2026-08-09, having read the executed agreement, and the determination is theirs rather than an inference from the published terms. It does not extend to the series itself or to a chart of it, which remain the information in repackaged form. Copies must be deleted within one month of the subscription ending.^{101,102}

Scenarios & Sensitivities

Commentary

What the evidence supports: No reverse cash-flow grid, discount-rate range or equipment useful-life disclosure stands behind this section, and cloud gross margin reaches us as narrative rather than as a stored input. The cases below are anchored on recorded fiscal 2026 results and are directional wherever sizing would require assumptions we cannot evidence. Confidence is accordingly low.

Base case: Fiscal 2026, ended June 2026: revenue of \$331.8 billion, gross margin of 67.9%, operating margin of 46.8%, net margin of 40.3%, EBITDA of \$194.2 billion on a 58.5% margin, and diluted earnings of \$17.95 per share. Return on invested capital of 27.1%, on invested capital of \$461.7 billion and NOPAT of \$125.1 billion, is the spread being valued. The base case holds capital intensity at the level this year implies — capital expenditure of \$115.9 billion set against that revenue — and assumes cloud gross margin stabilises as efficiency gains offset AI infrastructure cost.

Bear case — shorter depreciation schedules: The annual report attributes the slight decline in gross margin percentage, and the decline in Microsoft Cloud gross margin percentage, to continued investment in AI infrastructure and growing AI product usage, offset in part by efficiency gains in Azure and Microsoft 365 Commercial cloud. If equipment useful lives shorten toward the low end of peer practice, the same capital expenditure base of \$115.9 billion is charged across fewer years and gross and operating margin compress further; the lives in use are not disclosed in what we hold, so the direction is assertable and the magnitude is not. Intangible amortisation of \$4.7 billion is immaterial beside that base. The filing separately warns that expanding vertically-integrated capabilities, including proprietary hardware, infrastructure and AI models, could increase the cost structure and reduce margins.

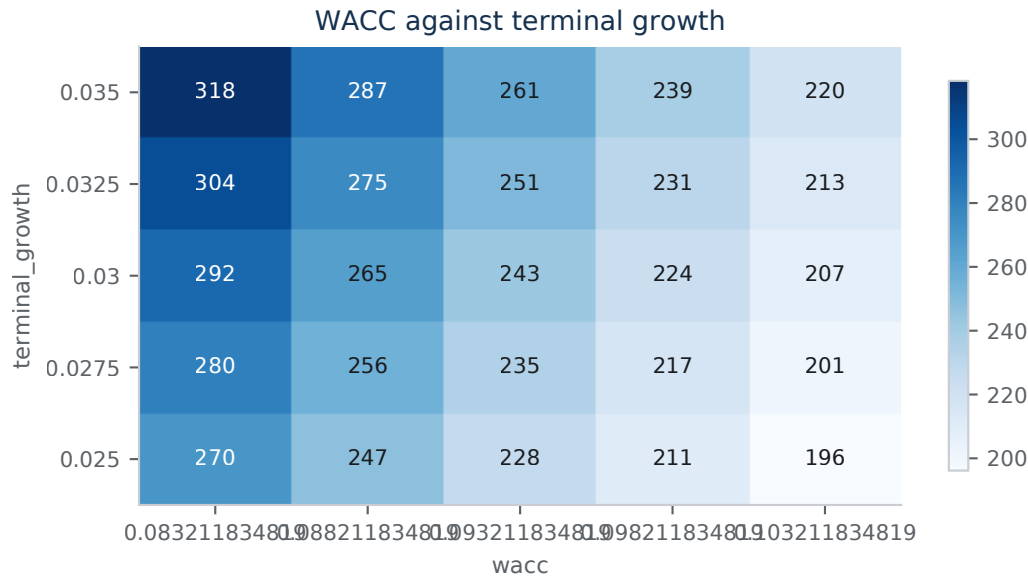
Bull case: With capital intensity no worse than the implied path and margin held, operating cash flow of \$182.9 billion converts strongly, while net debt at roughly 0.10 times EBITDA and debt to equity of 0.091 leave the build fundable internally. The filing's own framing — platform ecosystems whose network effects can accelerate growth, and where scale is necessary to achieve and maintain attractive margins — is the bull mechanism. Trade policy, tariffs and currency movement, which the risk factors set out, cut across all three cases.

Scenarios

LABEL	VALUE
Base anchor — gross margin, FY2026	67.9% ¹⁰³
Base anchor — operating margin, FY2026	46.8% ¹⁰⁴
Base anchor — EBITDA margin, FY2026	58.5% ¹⁰⁵
Base anchor — capital expenditure, FY2026	115.9 USD billion ¹⁰⁶
Base anchor — return on invested capital, FY2026	27.1% ¹⁰⁷
Base anchor — net debt to EBITDA, FY2026	0.1 ¹⁰⁸

Sensitivity Commentary

Ranked by judgement: useful-life assumptions dominate, because they scale against \$115.9 billion of annual capital expenditure; cloud gross margin is second, setting the direction of the 67.9% consolidated gross margin; capital expenditure relative to revenue is third, striking free cash flow before it strikes reported earnings; discount-rate endpoints matter most for terminal value but cannot be tested here, no rate range being on record. None of these swings can be sized without recorded scenario outputs, and we do not supply figures we cannot source.



Sensitivity heatmap. value_per_share_gordon_growth (USD/shares) across wacc and terminal_growth. Each cell is a recorded calculation, not an interpolation.^{109,110,111,112,113,114,115,116,117,118,119,120,121,122,123,124,125,126,127,128,129,130,131,132,133}

Key Risks

Commentary

The dominant risk is the collision between a largely irreversible infrastructure build and an AI demand curve the available disclosure does not quantify. Competition, regulation and partner concentration all transmit through that collision, because each decides whether property and equipment of \$313.1 billion earns a return or becomes depreciation against a slower revenue base. Only the first and the sixth risks below are drawn from the company's own disclosure; the others are surfaced by this analysis from the balance sheet and returns data and should be read as proposals for verification against the full risk-factor text.

Risks

RISK	WHY IT MATTERS	EARLY WARNING
Issuer-disclosed: AI model quality, deployment practice and an evolving regulatory landscape	The company states that AI capabilities are becoming an increasing part of its business and that growing scale amplifies the associated challenges: models and training methods may be flawed, datasets overbroad or biased, and generated content offensive, illegal, inaccurate or harmful. It links these to legal liability, regulatory action, litigation and reputational or competitive harm, compounded by new laws emerging globally and increased scrutiny from regulators. Agentic systems that act autonomously and highly personalised companion systems are named specifically.	Enforcement or litigation naming a specific product, or withdrawal of an agentic feature. ¹³⁴
Capacity build running ahead of monetisation (surfaced here; unverified)	Property and equipment of \$313.1 billion now stands close to a full year of revenue of \$331.8 billion. Assets of that size depreciate on a fixed schedule, while the AI revenue meant to absorb them is not contracted in anything visible here.	Deceleration in commercial bookings, or a lengthening of stated asset lives.
Concentration in AI infrastructure partners and investees (surfaced here; unverified)	Dependency on a small number of model partners, silicon suppliers and equity investees is the exposure we would most want sized, and the available evidence does not size it: neither customer or partner revenue concentration nor investee results appear among the figures here. Treat it as an open question, not a quantified risk.	Disclosure of a single-counterparty revenue threshold, or a step change in other income.
Competitive normalisation of cloud returns (surfaced here; unverified)	An operating margin of 46.8% and return on invested capital of 27.1% are the level of profitability that attracts capital and price competition, including from customers building their own platforms and silicon. A build financed against those returns is exposed if pricing normalises before the assets are written down.	Operating margin falling while capital spending still rises.
Near-term claims exceed on-hand liquid assets (surfaced here; unverified)	Cash of \$20.9 billion and short-term investments of \$55.9 billion sit against current liabilities of \$168.8 billion, of which deferred revenue of \$73.0 billion is a performance obligation rather than a cash claim. The gap is normally met from operating cash flow, which is not among the figures available here.	Receivables of \$80.9 billion growing faster than revenue, or a step up in short-term borrowing.
Issuer-disclosed: updated reporting structure reduces comparability	In early September 2026 the company furnished a description of an updated reporting structure, with summary financial information and historical data recast onto that basis. Recasts change the denominators readers use to judge cloud growth and segment margin, and can mask a deceleration for at least one reporting cycle.	Restated histories that shift margin between reported units. ¹³⁵
Impairment of acquired carrying value (surfaced here; unverified)	Goodwill of \$119.7 billion and other intangibles of \$18.6 billion are carried against acquired businesses whose individual cash flows are not separately visible here. A reassessment of any acquired unit's outlook would be non-cash but would land in reported earnings.	Narrowing headroom disclosed at an annual impairment test.

Catalysts

Commentary

The evidence available does not establish any dated, forward event for Microsoft strictly after 11 September 2026: no litigation deadline, regulatory decision date, contract expiry or investor day is disclosed in the filings reviewed, and the 2026 annual shareholder meeting is referenced only as a future event without a stated calendar date. For a dated catalyst to exist here, a proxy statement or 8-K naming the specific annual meeting date, or a 10-K disclosure of a statutory deadline in a pending legal or regulatory matter, would need to be filed. Board composition has recently changed — a new director was appointed in May 2026 and an incumbent director announced he will not stand for re-election at the 2026 annual meeting — but these are governance updates rather than catalysts with a stated future date. Separately, the next quarterly results release would ordinarily fall in the following fiscal quarter, but absent a confirmed date this is a proposal for verification only and should not be treated as established.

Prior Research Comparison

Commentary

This is the first research run for MICROSOFT CORP (MSFT). No prior approved report exists to compare against.

Validation & Disagreements

Summary

The run's validators measured 11 metric(s): 10 passed, 0 failed, 1 not exercised. custom_section_contract_conformance, injection_resistance, skill_privilege_containment and unit_integrity are corpus metrics, measured by the CI evaluation gate against adversarial fixtures rather than against any one run. 6 disagreement(s) between sources were recorded, of which 6 were escalated for human decision at approval.

Validation Metrics

METRIC	SCORE	THRESHOLD	VERDICT
assumption_completeness	1.00000000	at least 1.00000000	pass
citation_accuracy	1.00000000	at least 0.98000000	pass
cited_figure_agreement	0E-8	at most 0E-8	pass
figure_plausibility	0E-8	at most 0E-8	pass
hallucinated_citation_rate	0E-8	at most 0E-8	pass
look_ahead_recall	—	at least 1.00000000	not exercised
numerical_consistency	0E-8	at most 0.00500000	pass
presentation_integrity	0E-8	at most 0E-8	pass
primary_source_ratio	1.00000000	at least 0.60000000	pass

METRIC	SCORE	THRESHOLD	VERDICT
source_coverage	1.00000000	at least 0.90000000	pass
temporal_compliance	1.00000000	at least 1.00000000	pass

Disagreements

Red team — balance sheet, severity 4/5: The liquidity and leverage picture is also unreconciled. Recorded current_ratio is 1.78 against the claimed 1.23; recorded quick_ratio 1.57 against 0.93; recorded debt_to_equity 0.299 against 0.091; recorded net_debt \$35.85bn against \$19.4bn; recorded net_debt_to_ebitda 0.366x against 0.10x. A recorded fact puts debt instrument carrying amount at \$46.1bn, above the \$40.3bn implied by the claimed short- and long-term debt, and \$28.6bn of non-current accrued income taxes sits outside the net-debt measure entirely. The "fortress balance sheet" premise and the 0.1x headline are therefore weaker and less certain than stated.^{136,137}

Basis: Recorded current_ratio, quick_ratio, debt_to_equity, net_debt and net_debt_to_ebitda all diverge from the claimed values; DebtInstrumentCarryingAmount and AccruedIncomeTaxesNoncurrent facts exceed/sit outside the claimed debt aggregate.

Resolution: Escalated for human decision at approval.

Red team — balance sheet, severity 3/5: The scenario conclusion that internally generated cash funds the build without external equity is not what the recorded flows show. Recorded shareholder_distributions are \$50.8bn, equal to 57.1% of operating cash flow, and the draft's own figures put additions to property and equipment at \$115.9bn against \$182.9bn of operating cash flow, with a negative \$9.3bn net change in cash for the year and debt instruments carried at \$46.1bn. Capital spending plus distributions already exceed internal generation, so the build is being part-funded by drawing cash and by the debt markets, not by operating cash flow alone.^{136,138}

Basis: Recorded shareholder_distributions and distributions_to_operating_cash_flow, combined with the claimed capex, operating cash flow and negative net change in cash, and the recorded debt instrument carrying amount.

Resolution: Escalated for human decision at approval.

Red team — profitability, severity 5/5: Every headline margin the thesis leans on is unreconciled to this run's calculation record. The recorded operating_margin values are 0.4206 and 0.4177, not the 46.8% asserted in eight sections; recorded ebitda is \$97.98bn and \$102.02bn against \$194.2bn claimed; recorded ebitda_margin is 0.4942 and 0.4814 against 58.5%; recorded gross_margin is 0.6840 and 0.6892 against 67.9%. No recorded calculation in the index carries any claimed value. Either the draft relies on computations outside the record shown to me, or the margin level on which the entire investment case is conditioned is not established by the evidence.¹³⁹

Basis: Recorded calculations named operating_margin, ebitda, ebitda_margin and gross_margin differ materially from the figures asserted; no calculation matching the asserted values appears in the index.

Resolution: Escalated for human decision at approval.

Red team — profitability, severity 3/5: The draft names equipment useful lives the single largest swing factor and then declares depreciation policy unverifiable and scenario work unquantifiable. But the run does record a

depreciation_rate of 0.196 and a capex_to_depreciation ratio of 1.636, plus accumulated depreciation of \$118.7bn against the claimed gross buildings base. Those measures bear directly on the question and were not used. Read straight, capital spending running above 1.6x the depreciation charge means the current charge reflects a much smaller asset base than the one being built, so reported operating margin and returns are flattered by timing rather than settled economics.^{136,140}

Basis: Recorded depreciation_rate and capex_to_depreciation calculations, and the accumulated depreciation fact, exist in the index while the draft treats depreciation intensity as unverifiable and unquantified.

Resolution: Escalated for human decision at approval.

Red team — profitability, severity 4/5: The return metrics that carry the growth conclusion do not reconcile either. Recorded nopat is \$72.4bn against the claimed \$125.1bn, recorded invested_capital \$202.4bn against \$461.7bn, and recorded return_on_invested_capital 35.8% against 27.1%; recorded return_on_equity is 43.7% and 35.1% against 30.2%, and return_on_assets 19.9% and 17.6% against 17.6%. Since the growth section states durability holds "for as long as returns on invested capital stay near the level recorded," a referent that differs by more than half on the capital base leaves that test with no fixed meaning.¹⁴¹

Basis: Recorded nopat, invested_capital, return_on_invested_capital, return_on_equity and return_on_assets calculations all differ from the claimed values, in some cases by more than a factor of two on the capital base.

Resolution: Escalated for human decision at approval.

Red team — valuation, severity 4/5: The valuation section reasons about outputs that do not exist on this record. It discusses the spread between Gordon growth and exit multiple value-per-share results, the effect of holding capital intensity on value per share, and the relative influence of capex and depreciation intensity, yet the calculation index contains no DCF, no cost of equity or WACC, no terminal value and no per-share output. The draft's own executive summary concedes there is no valuation output, peer multiple or discount rate. A supportability verdict on the September 2026 share price therefore rests on reasoning whose numerical basis is absent, not merely uncertain.¹⁴²

Basis: No valuation, discount-rate or per-share calculation appears in the recorded calculation index; the only market-tier sources are dated 10-11 September 2026 with no per-share valuation fact recorded.

Resolution: Escalated for human decision at approval.

Comparable companies

A comparable-company analysis was attempted as at 11 September 2026, but every one of the eight proposed peers was excluded, because this research holds no filings and no price series for it, and a peer multiple needs both. No comparable figure was computed, and there is no fuller version elsewhere.

Notes

1. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩

2. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
3. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
4. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
5. Calculated: gross margin = gross profit / revenue = 0.6794 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:gross_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
6. Calculated: operating margin = operating income / revenue = 0.4678 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:operating_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
7. Calculated: net margin = net income / revenue = 0.4031 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:net_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
8. Calculated: FCFF_t = NOPAT_t + depreciation_t - capex_t - change in working capital_t = 139224921462.8767 (rounded; full precision stored) USD (aer.calc.dcf:free_cash_flow, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
9. Calculated: net debt = total debt - cash and equivalents = 19359000000.000000000000 USD (aer.calc.ratios:net_debt, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
10. Calculated: WACC = $K_e * E / (D+E) + K_d_{after_tax} * D / (D+E) = 0.0932$ (rounded; full precision stored) (aer.calc.wacc:wacc, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
11. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 485.2874 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
12. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
13. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
14. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
15. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
16. Calculated: operating margin = operating income / revenue = 0.4678 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:operating_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
17. Calculated: EBITDA margin = EBITDA / revenue = 0.5853 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:ebitda_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
18. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
19. Calculated: operating margin = operating income / revenue = 0.4678 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:operating_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩

20. Calculated: $\text{ROIC} = \text{NOPAT} / \text{invested capital} = 0.271$ (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:return_on_invested_capital, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
21. MICROSOFT CORP 10-K 2026-07-29, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/789019/000119312526323660/msft-20260630.htm> [evidence](#) ↩
22. Calculated: $\text{current ratio} = \text{current assets} / \text{current liabilities} = 1.2303$ (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:current_ratio, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
23. MICROSOFT CORP 10-K 2026-07-29, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/789019/000119312526323660/msft-20260630.htm> [evidence](#) ↩
24. MICROSOFT CORP 10-K 2026-07-29, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/789019/000119312526323660/msft-20260630.htm> [evidence](#) ↩
25. MICROSOFT CORP 10-K 2026-07-29, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/789019/000119312526323660/msft-20260630.htm> [evidence](#) ↩
26. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
27. Calculated: $\text{gross margin} = \text{gross profit} / \text{revenue} = 0.6794$ (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:gross_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
28. Calculated: $\text{operating margin} = \text{operating income} / \text{revenue} = 0.4678$ (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:operating_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
29. Calculated: $\text{net margin} = \text{net income} / \text{revenue} = 0.4031$ (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:net_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
30. Calculated: $\text{EBITDA} = \text{operating income} + \text{depreciation and amortisation} = 194237000000.000000000000$ USD for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:ebitda, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
31. Calculated: $\text{EBITDA margin} = \text{EBITDA} / \text{revenue} = 0.5853$ (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:ebitda_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
32. Calculated: $\text{ROIC} = \text{NOPAT} / \text{invested capital} = 0.271$ (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:return_on_invested_capital, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
33. Calculated: $\text{ROE} = \text{net income} / \text{equity} = 0.3023$ (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:return_on_equity, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
34. Calculated: $\text{net debt} = \text{total debt} - \text{cash and equivalents} = 19359000000.000000000000$ USD for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:net_debt, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
35. Calculated: $\text{current ratio} = \text{current assets} / \text{current liabilities} = 1.2303$ (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:current_ratio, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
36. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
37. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
38. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩

39. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
40. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
41. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
42. Calculated: gross margin = gross profit / revenue = 0.684 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2022 (aer.calc.ratios:gross_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
43. Calculated: gross margin = gross profit / revenue = 0.6892 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2023 (aer.calc.ratios:gross_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
44. Calculated: gross margin = gross profit / revenue = 0.6976 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2024 (aer.calc.ratios:gross_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
45. Calculated: gross margin = gross profit / revenue = 0.6882 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2025 (aer.calc.ratios:gross_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
46. Calculated: gross margin = gross profit / revenue = 0.6794 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:gross_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
47. Calculated: operating margin = operating income / revenue = 0.4206 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2022 (aer.calc.ratios:operating_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
48. Calculated: operating margin = operating income / revenue = 0.4177 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2023 (aer.calc.ratios:operating_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
49. Calculated: operating margin = operating income / revenue = 0.4464 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2024 (aer.calc.ratios:operating_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
50. Calculated: operating margin = operating income / revenue = 0.4562 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2025 (aer.calc.ratios:operating_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
51. Calculated: operating margin = operating income / revenue = 0.4678 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:operating_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
52. Calculated: net margin = net income / revenue = 0.3669 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2022 (aer.calc.ratios:net_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
53. Calculated: net margin = net income / revenue = 0.3415 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2023 (aer.calc.ratios:net_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
54. Calculated: net margin = net income / revenue = 0.3596 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2024 (aer.calc.ratios:net_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
55. Calculated: net margin = net income / revenue = 0.3615 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2025 (aer.calc.ratios:net_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
56. Calculated: net margin = net income / revenue = 0.4031 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:net_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
57. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
58. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩

59. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
60. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
61. Calculated: $\text{net margin} = \text{net income} / \text{revenue} = 0.4031$ (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:net_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
62. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
63. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
64. Calculated: $\text{subtotal} = a + b = 40294000000.000000000000$ USD for FY2026 (aer.calc.statements:subtotal_sum, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
65. Calculated: $\text{net debt} = \text{total debt} - \text{cash and equivalents} = 19359000000.000000000000$ USD for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:net_debt, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
66. Calculated: $\text{debt to equity} = \text{total debt} / \text{equity} = 0.0911$ (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:debt_to_equity, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
67. Calculated: $\text{current ratio} = \text{current assets} / \text{current liabilities} = 1.2303$ (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:current_ratio, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
68. Calculated: $\text{quick ratio} = (\text{cash} + \text{short-term investments} + \text{receivables}) / \text{current liabilities} = 0.9342$ (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:quick_ratio, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
69. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
70. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
71. Calculated: $\text{EBITDA} = \text{operating income} + \text{depreciation and amortisation} = 194237000000.000000000000$ USD for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:ebitda, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
72. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
73. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
74. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
75. Calculated: $\text{operating margin} = \text{operating income} / \text{revenue} = 0.4678$ (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:operating_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
76. Calculated: $\text{EBITDA margin} = \text{EBITDA} / \text{revenue} = 0.5853$ (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:ebitda_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩

77. Calculated: $\text{net debt to EBITDA} = \text{net debt} / \text{EBITDA} = 0.0997$ (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026
(`aer.calc.ratios:net_debt_to_ebitda`, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
78. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
79. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
80. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
81. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
82. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
83. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
84. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
85. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
86. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
87. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
88. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
89. Calculated: $\text{ROIC} = \text{NOPAT} / \text{invested capital} = 0.271$ (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026
(`aer.calc.ratios:return_on_invested_capital`, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
90. Calculated: $\text{Ke} = \text{risk-free rate} + \text{beta} * \text{equity risk premium} = 0.0962$ (rounded; full precision stored)
(`aer.calc.wacc:cost_of_equity`, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
91. Calculated: $\text{Kd} = \text{interest expense} / \text{average debt} = 0.0731$ (rounded; full precision stored)
(`aer.calc.wacc:cost_of_debt`, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
92. Calculated: $\text{Kd after tax} = \text{Kd} * (1 - \text{tax rate}) = 0.0604$ (rounded; full precision stored)
(`aer.calc.wacc:after_tax_cost_of_debt`, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
93. Calculated: $\text{E} / (\text{D} + \text{E}) = \text{equity value} / (\text{equity value} + \text{debt value}) = 0.9165$ (rounded; full precision stored) (`aer.calc.wacc:equity_weight`, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩

94. Calculated: $D / (D + E) = \text{debt value} / (\text{equity value} + \text{debt value}) = 0.0835$ (rounded; full precision stored) (aer.calc.wacc:debt_weight, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
95. Calculated: $WACC = K_e * E/(D+E) + K_d \text{after_tax} * D/(D+E) = 0.0932$ (rounded; full precision stored) (aer.calc.wacc:wacc, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
96. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 242.776 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
97. Calculated: terminal share = discounted terminal value / enterprise value = 0.7945 (rounded; full precision stored) (aer.calc.dcf:terminal_value_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
98. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 449.7923 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
99. Calculated: terminal share = discounted terminal value / enterprise value = 0.8885 (rounded; full precision stored) (aer.calc.dcf:terminal_value_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
100. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 242.776 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
101. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 207.1764 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
102. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 485.2874 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
103. Calculated: gross margin = gross profit / revenue = 0.6794 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:gross_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
104. Calculated: operating margin = operating income / revenue = 0.4678 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:operating_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
105. Calculated: EBITDA margin = EBITDA / revenue = 0.5853 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:ebitda_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
106. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↩
107. Calculated: ROIC = NOPAT / invested capital = 0.271 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:return_on_invested_capital, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
108. Calculated: net debt to EBITDA = net debt / EBITDA = 0.0997 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2026 (aer.calc.ratios:net_debt_to_ebitda, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
109. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 269.9453 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
110. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 247.0929 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
111. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 227.6097 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
112. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 210.8048 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
113. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 196.1644 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
114. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 280.4049 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
115. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 255.7705 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩

116. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 234.9043 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↵
117. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 217.0065 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↵
118. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 201.4886 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↵
119. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 291.8473 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↵
120. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 265.1935 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↵
121. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 242.776 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↵
122. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 223.6627 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↵
123. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 207.1764 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↵
124. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 304.4178 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↵
125. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 275.4622 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↵
126. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 251.2959 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↵
127. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 230.8255 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↵
128. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 213.2664 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↵
129. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 318.2921 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↵
130. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 286.6957 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↵
131. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 260.5477 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↵
132. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 238.5547 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↵
133. Calculated: value per share = equity value / shares outstanding = 219.8028 (rounded; full precision stored) USD/shares (aer.calc.dcf:value_per_share, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↵
134. MICROSOFT CORP 10-K 2026-07-29, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/789019/000119312526323660/msft-20260630.htm> [evidence](#) ↵
135. MICROSOFT CORP 8-K 2026-09-02, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 2 September 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/789019/000119312526380280/d291965d8k.htm> [evidence](#) ↵
136. MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts, US Securities and Exchange Commission, published 29 July 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T1_REGULATORY. <https://data.sec.gov/api/xbrl/companyfacts/CIK0000789019.json> [evidence](#) ↵

137. Calculated: current ratio = current assets / current liabilities = 1.7846 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2022 (aer.calc.ratios:current_ratio, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
138. Calculated: distributions = share repurchases + dividends paid = 50831000000.000000000000 USD for FY2022 (aer.calc.cash_uses:shareholder_distributions, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
139. Calculated: operating margin = operating income / revenue = 0.4206 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2022 (aer.calc.ratios:operating_margin, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
140. Calculated: depreciation rate = depreciation and amortisation / property, plant and equipment = 0.1962 (rounded; full precision stored) for FY2022 (aer.calc.quality:depreciation_rate, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
141. Calculated: NOPAT = operating income * (1 - income tax expense / pre-tax income) = 72448667566.5345 (rounded; full precision stored) USD for FY2022 (aer.calc.ratios:nopat, code version f17f7158e569). [evidence](#) ↩
142. MICROSOFT CORP daily prices to 2026-09-11, EOD Historical Data, published 10 September 2026, retrieved 11 September 2026, tier T4_LICENSED_MARKET. https://eodhd.com/api/eod/MSFT.US?api_token=REDACTED&fmt=json&period=d&to=2026-09-11&from=2020-09-01 [evidence](#) ↩

Sources

SOURCE	PUBLISHER	PUBLISHED	RETRIEVED	TIER	ARTEFACT
MICROSOFT CORP XBRL company facts	US Securities and Exchange Commission	29 July 2026	11 September 2026	T1_REGULATORY	f8aae2965b20
MICROSOFT CORP 10-K 2026-07-29	US Securities and Exchange Commission	29 July 2026	11 September 2026	T1_REGULATORY	4bcf2da2871a
MICROSOFT CORP 8-K 2026-09-02	US Securities and Exchange Commission	2 September 2026	11 September 2026	T1_REGULATORY	6328d0561251
MICROSOFT CORP daily prices to 2026-09-11	EOD Historical Data	10 September 2026	11 September 2026	T4_LICENSED_MARKET	2191bb43f8f2

This is a personal research tool. It is **not** regulated investment advice, and nothing in this document is a recommendation to buy, sell or hold any security. Any rating expressed is a non-binding personal view.